

SINNER OUTCLASSES THE ELITE CLUB

By winning his first ATP Finals title, Sinner became **only the third player**, besides Novak Djokovic and Roger Federer, to win this tournament along with the Australian and US Open in the same year.

Paul Fein

“The gulf between Sinner and everyone else in this tournament is a pretty big body of water.” — Jim Courier, former world No. 1.

With the preternatural calmness of Björn Borg, the technical perfection of Novak Djokovic, and the endearing humility of Rafael Nadal, an Italian sensation with a surname that’s a misnomer has taken over men’s tennis. He has also become wildly popular, particularly in football-mad Italy.

Jannik Sinner had already clinched the year-end No. 1 ranking a month before the season-ending Nitto ATP Finals in Turin. He underscored his near-total hard-court domination this season by thrashing every opponent without dropping a set — a feat last achieved in 1986 by Ivan Lendl.

Even more impressively, Sinner became only the third player, besides superstars Djokovic and Roger Federer, to win the three biggest hard-court events — the Australian and US Opens and this tournament — in the same year.

In contrast to Carlos Alcaraz’s panache — bright

GETTY IMAGES